songs, and they were incredibly helpful in organising the whole thing," says Chaudhuri. "We recorded the songs live in an old converted church over just two days."

The live recording process—all the musicians playing in the same room, with minimal overdubs or studio trickery—gives the album's five tracks a loose, improvisational feel that only adds to the serendipitous wonder of these compositions. Lead single "In a Something Way/ The National Anthem" explores consonances between Joe Zawinul's cinematic composition and Rabindranath Tagore's Indian national anthem. Released to mark the 75th year of Indian independence, accompanied by an impressionist music video focused on a painting of the Indian flag, Chaudhuri hopes the track will encourage Indian artists and writers to look at nationalist symbols in ways that go beyond their symbolic baggage—as works of art, music, literature.

He takes a slightly different approach on opener "My Name is Gauhar Jaan", inspired by Indian-Armenian singer Gauhar Jaan (born Angelina Yeoward) and her habit of ending her 78rpm records with that self-identifying phrase. Chaudhuri riffs on the mystery of that statement, attempting to "ventriloquise" her. "But I'm doing it implausibly, you know?" he says. "I'm not trying to imitate her or imagine her through period detail. I'm taking the freedom to imagine her in a different musical context."

On "Across the Universe" and "The End-Live", he returns to more familiar territory, his experiments with serendipitous 'mishearings'. The former originated from a bit of improvisational humming while stuck in traffic, the latter when he heard sitar *jhala* in Robert Krieger's iconic The Doors riff. But both renditions treat the originals as a jumping-off point, using phrases and references from the rock classics as signposts for expansive, *raga*-led expeditions into the liminal soundscapes between different traditions and canons.

"It's just this coming together of so many things, so many worlds, through this kind of fortuitous instinct and moment of listening," says Chaudhuri, who is looking forward to taking the project on the road. ■

Bhanuj Kappal

MUSIC

Let the Music Play

Upcoming music festivals across India

→ SYMPOSIUM BEACH FESTIVAL, GOA *(Feb. 17-20)*



This eagerly anticipated psytrance festival held through the night on Vagator's Dream Beach in Goa features artists like The Dog of Tears, Daash, Elowins, Flipknot, Gismo, Psykovsky and Life Enjoyers Club. The foot-tapping fest will also see Kindzazda and Will O Wisp debut their Ota Okuma.

→ ODDBALL FESTIVAL, MULTI-CITY

Feb. 17 (Mumbai), Feb. 18 (Bengaluru), Feb. 19 (New Delhi)

Rock/ funk trailblazers The Aristocrats are the headline act in the inaugural edition of this multi-city travelling event put together by BlueTree and ODDC. The virtuoso trio of guitarist Guthrie Govan, bassist Bryan Beller and drummer



Marco Minnemann are returning to India for the first time since the pandemic. They will be joined by folk-metal frontrunners Bloodywood, YouTube-famous rock act KOIAI feat. Li-Sa-X and instrumental rock favourites Blackstratblues. The tagline is 'The Epic, Eccentric and The Extraordinary', and we music geeks have expectations to match.

→ CAMPFIRE MUSIC FESTIVAL, AHMEDABAD *(Feb. 18-19)*

Another festival debuting this February, it promises 'music, bonfire, barbeque and memories for life', and will have Amdavadis swaying to indie, folk, Sufi and Bollywood rhythms. The artist line-up on Day 1 includes Paras Dhar, Chirag Todi and Heat Sink, Akshath Acharya and Munaf Luhar. On Day 2, there's Mooralala Marwada, Anumita Nadesan, Shashwat Bullusu and Meera Desai. Besides the promised bonfire, there will be lip-smacking food and other fun activities.

↓ VH1 SUPERSONIC, PUNE *(Feb. 24-26)*

This year's edition promises to be a cultural potpourri of art, music, fashion and food. British pop singer Anne-Marie is headlining the festival, while other major acts are rappers Tyga and **Divine**, Nigerian sensation CKay, *Gehraaiyan* fame OAFF X Savera, indie artist Prateek Kuhad, multi-hyphenate Farhan Akhtar, Peter Cat Recording Co. and many more. This is one music festival you don't want to miss.





↑ Jazz Weekender: Winter Edition, New Delhi *(Feb. 25-26)*

Delhi looks all set to bid goodbye to winter with a cosmopolitan celebration of music. A mix of jazz, funk and R&B, the diverse set of cross-genre artists includes Argentina's Desmadre Orkesta, hip-hop artist Cero Ismael from Amsterdam, the Middle Eastern-inflected jazz group Noon, singer Kayan, Tara Lily and Sahil Vasudeva Ensemble.

Amit Dixit